

Table 1: Summary Statistics

Variable	Unit	N	Mean	SD	Min	P25	Median	P75	Max
<i>A. Independent Variables</i>									
GEPU_log	C	88,205	4.6872	0.3672	3.8626	4.3797	4.7238	4.9666	5.5106
GPR_log	C	88,205	4.5838	0.2554	4.1614	4.4165	4.5111	4.7251	5.8825
PRisk	C	85,995	99.6187	146.5189	0.0000	17.0778	53.3729	120.1973	1192.4308
PRisk_lag	C	81,766	99.6985	146.6775	0.0000	17.1376	53.4047	120.2397	1192.4308
PRisk_lag2	C	80,627	99.9614	147.2392	0.0000	17.1702	53.4446	120.2666	1192.4308
TotalSimilarity	F	22,403	3.4277	5.6522	1.0000	1.1246	1.5865	3.0903	80.1876
US_EPU_log	C	88,205	4.7123	0.3661	3.8018	4.4805	4.6891	4.9625	5.6478
UncAnsCEO	C	71,748	0.7806	0.3925	0.0000	0.5147	0.7415	1.0018	2.5874
UncAnsMgr	C	84,729	0.8189	0.3344	0.0000	0.5891	0.7874	1.0135	2.1014
UncAnsNoCEO	C	80,387	0.8505	0.5457	0.0000	0.5042	0.7913	1.1204	3.1912
UncPreCEO	C	71,727	0.6602	0.3917	0.0000	0.3810	0.6001	0.8723	2.2432
UncPreMgr	C	86,795	0.8938	0.3508	0.0000	0.6456	0.8534	1.0952	2.1548
UncPreNoCEO	C	85,444	1.1176	0.6136	0.0000	0.7185	1.0123	1.3822	4.4188
<i>B. Dependent Variables</i>									
BGTAvg_Amihud	C	86,978	0.0167	0.1003	0.0000	0.0002	0.0010	0.0041	2.3333
BGTAvg_Amihud_lead1	C	82,808	0.0158	0.0980	0.0000	0.0002	0.0009	0.0038	2.3333
BGTAvg_Spread	C	87,086	0.0018	0.0027	0.0001	0.0005	0.0009	0.0018	0.0168
BGTAvg_Spread_lead1	C	82,914	0.0017	0.0025	0.0001	0.0004	0.0009	0.0017	0.0168
BGTDelta_Amihud	C	86,557	-0.0011	0.0281	-0.6913	-0.0004	-0.0000	0.0001	0.3352
BGTDelta_Amihud_lead1	C	82,475	-0.0009	0.0271	-0.6913	-0.0003	-0.0000	0.0001	0.3352
BGTDelta_Spread	C	85,189	-0.0001	0.0008	-0.0044	-0.0002	-0.0000	0.0001	0.0030
BGTDelta_Spread_lead1	C	81,145	-0.0001	0.0008	-0.0044	-0.0002	-0.0000	0.0001	0.0030
BGTLevel_Amihud	C	86,935	0.0151	0.0847	0.0000	0.0002	0.0009	0.0038	1.6839
BGTLevel_Amihud_lead1	C	82,766	0.0143	0.0831	0.0000	0.0002	0.0009	0.0035	1.6839
BGTLevel_Spread	C	87,018	0.0017	0.0026	0.0001	0.0004	0.0009	0.0017	0.0164
BGTLevel_Spread_lead1	C	82,843	0.0016	0.0024	0.0001	0.0004	0.0009	0.0016	0.0164
CCCL	C	88,205	0.0032	0.0563	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000
Capex	C	87,627	0.0487	0.0536	0.0000	0.0176	0.0324	0.0592	0.5203
Capex_lead	C	81,582	0.0481	0.0525	0.0000	0.0175	0.0321	0.0585	0.5203
Capex_lead2	C	73,542	0.0476	0.0513	0.0000	0.0175	0.0321	0.0581	0.5203
Capex_lead3	C	66,062	0.0472	0.0506	0.0000	0.0174	0.0319	0.0576	0.5203
Capex_lead4	C	58,987	0.0465	0.0498	0.0000	0.0172	0.0316	0.0569	0.5203
CashRatio	C	87,990	0.1708	0.1806	0.0000	0.0368	0.1047	0.2435	0.9938
CashRatio_lead	C	82,236	0.1715	0.1748	0.0000	0.0407	0.1112	0.2447	0.9938
ChangDebtChoice	C	20,448	0.7598	0.4272	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000
ChangDebtChoice_lead	C	18,720	0.7974	0.4019	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000
ChangExternalFunding	C	87,532	0.2506	0.4334	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000
ChangExternalFunding_lead	C	81,563	0.2446	0.4299	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000
DISP	C	37,446	0.0017	0.0028	0.0000	0.0003	0.0007	0.0018	0.0179
DISP_lead	C	37,015	0.0017	0.0027	0.0000	0.0003	0.0007	0.0018	0.0179
DSPREAD	C	87,119	-0.0002	0.0017	-0.0081	-0.0004	-0.0000	0.0001	0.0064
DSPREAD_lead1	C	82,964	-0.0002	0.0016	-0.0081	-0.0004	-0.0000	0.0001	0.0064
DebtToCapital	C	87,760	0.3450	0.3541	0.0000	0.0689	0.3064	0.4914	4.4691
DebtToCapital_lead	C	82,024	0.3495	0.3536	0.0000	0.0773	0.3110	0.4958	4.4691
DeltaILLIQ	C	86,906	-0.0013	0.0249	-0.5050	-0.0006	-0.0000	0.0001	0.3003
DeltaILLIQ_lead1	C	82,735	-0.0012	0.0243	-0.5050	-0.0005	-0.0000	0.0001	0.3003
DivPayerQ	C	88,134	0.4235	0.4941	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000
DivPayerQ_lead1	C	83,755	0.4290	0.4949	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000
EquityDelayCon_lead	F	13,212	-0.0270	0.0772	-0.2577	-0.0814	-0.0293	0.0233	0.3006
Leverage	C	87,994	0.2330	0.2240	0.0000	0.0470	0.2065	0.3455	3.9453
Leverage_lead	C	82,242	0.2352	0.2248	0.0000	0.0530	0.2090	0.3480	3.9453
PayoutRatio_q	C	70,695	0.2420	0.6534	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.2794	9.2194
PayoutRatio_q_lead_qtr	C	68,167	0.2437	0.6562	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.2816	9.2194
PostCallAmihud	C	86,906	0.0118	0.0680	0.0000	0.0002	0.0007	0.0031	1.9001
PostCallAmihud_lead1	C	82,735	0.0112	0.0669	0.0000	0.0002	0.0007	0.0028	1.9001
PostCallSpread	C	87,119	0.0017	0.0028	-0.0075	0.0004	0.0008	0.0017	0.0250
PostCallSpread_lead1	C	82,964	0.0016	0.0027	-0.0075	0.0004	0.0008	0.0016	0.0250
RDSales	C	87,647	0.1047	0.9342	0.0000	0.0000	0.0048	0.0636	39.7688
RDSales_lead	C	81,607	0.0990	0.9084	0.0000	0.0000	0.0050	0.0638	39.7688
RepurchaseIntensity	C	83,734	0.0073	0.0148	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0074	0.0919
RepurchaseIntensity_lead_qtr	C	80,289	0.0075	0.0149	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0078	0.0919
SEC_Letters_fwd	C	88,205	0.1264	0.4873	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	12.0000
<i>C. Firm Controls</i>									
AbsSurpDec	C	61,544	2.9300	1.4255	0.0000	2.0000	3.0000	4.0000	5.0000
CashFlowAt	C	87,670	0.1019	0.1147	-3.0324	0.0608	0.1032	0.1526	0.4874
DISP_lag	C	36,411	0.0016	0.0027	0.0000	0.0003	0.0007	0.0017	0.0179
DailyVola	C	82,599	36.7556	21.2437	9.4388	22.9709	31.2762	43.8148	211.9160

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Variable	Unit	N	Mean	SD	Min	P25	Median	P75	Max
DivDummy	C	88,134	0.4755	0.4994	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000
EarnVol	C	87,440	0.0701	0.1907	0.0006	0.0163	0.0315	0.0695	19.5101
FirmMat	C	87,571	-0.0432	2.1826	-317.5714	-0.0078	0.2191	0.4195	0.9252
Loss	C	88,129	0.1953	0.3964	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000
NegCall	C	86,858	0.9210	0.3024	0.0000	0.7038	0.8798	1.0943	2.3901
ROA	C	87,552	0.0386	0.1330	-3.9826	0.0146	0.0525	0.0925	0.5490
SalesGrowth	C	87,506	0.1173	0.3849	-1.0000	-0.0043	0.0745	0.1762	10.3051
StockPrice	C	87,188	38.6939	51.7195	0.0345	14.8975	28.2400	48.1700	2080.0200
SurpDec	C	61,544	1.2085	3.0260	-5.0000	-1.0000	2.0000	4.0000	5.0000
TobinsQ	C	87,363	2.1363	1.5197	0.3847	1.2681	1.6791	2.4362	35.6144
Turnover	C	87,188	0.0273	0.0420	0.0000	0.0083	0.0160	0.0310	3.7726
UncQue	C	81,031	1.4398	0.4831	0.0000	1.1216	1.4108	1.7268	3.5945
lnAssets	C	87,994	7.4710	1.6607	-0.5692	6.3008	7.3763	8.5436	12.4592
sCFO	C	83,662	0.0619	0.2233	0.0014	0.0236	0.0395	0.0664	32.4035

Notes: Summary statistics for variables used in the hypothesis tests. Sample period: 2002–2018. Anchor sample (H1, Main): 88,205 earnings-call observations across 1,884 firms. Unit column: C = call-level, F = firm-year. N varies by row because each variable is summarized on its anchor panel's Main sample (complete cases per variable); per-suite samples differ due to lags, control availability, and merges.